

Headstart
MENTORING

ROAD TO YOUR FIRST GRAD OFFER

IN AUSTRALIA



STAGE 4: FINAL BOSS



Based on:

- Conversations with 500+ students/grads
- 30+ offers secured across Tech/Business/Engineering

YOU ARE HERE

STAGE 4: FINAL BOSS



STAGE 3: QUALIFIERS			STAGE 4: FINAL BOSS		
JOBS APPLIED	50 - 200+		JOBS APPLIED	50 - 200+	
INTERVIEWS	Recorded Interviews: 3+ Screening Calls/Online Interviews: 3+		INTERVIEWS	Recorded Interviews: 3+ Screening Calls/Online Interviews: 5+ F2F Interviews: 2+	
# OF PEOPLE HERE CURRENTLY	13,800 (10% of University Students in Australia [Students studying Biz/Tech/Eng])		# OF PEOPLE HERE CURRENTLY	20,700 (15% of University Students in Australia [Students studying Biz/Tech/Engineer in their Last Year] are here now)	
CONSTRAINTS		TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE	CONSTRAINTS		TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE
SCREENING CALLS/ONLINE INTERVIEWS	You don't know the difference between a screening call/online interview vs an in-person interview	You understand the difference between a screening call/online interview vs an in-person interview	GROUP CASE STUDY	You don't exactly know how you should behave in group case studies	You understand the best principles you must do in group case studies
INTERVIEWS	You don't know the difference between: Hiring manager vs Recruiter/Talent Acquisition vs Recruitment Agency	You are able to cater to the needs of the hiring manager	F2F INTERVIEWS	You have prepared for the interview with a lot of hard work, but always fall short and don't understand why	You understand you must have a Unique Value Proposition / Unique and Relevant Stories / Personal Connection, on top of hard work and preparation, to maximise your chance.

0. FOUNDATION

1. VISIBILITY

2. CONNECTIONS

3. QUALIFIERS

4. FINAL BOSS



STAGE 4: FINAL BOSS

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INDIVIDUAL CASE STUDY	You don't know how to prepare for them or how to do well	You understand the principles of doing well in them, and the hidden things you can do during the case study

Think you are not a strong enough candidate? Head to ‘[Appendix - Page 1](#)’ to see if you have at least 3 out of 6 strong traits.

WHEN YOU ARE AT: “STAGE 4: FINAL BOSS”

The advice is based on:

- Conversations with 500+ students/grads
- 30+ offers secured by across Tech/Business/Engineering

Headstart
MENTORING

Welcome to Stage 4 - you are already in the top 15% of candidates, and you are SO CLOSE to that offer. However, after doing 1-2 face to face interviews/assessment centres, you still ended up being rejected.

Your goal is simple: To understand how to impress and leave a lasting memory in the interviewer's mind. This is what this resource will cover.

HERE'S HOW YOU ARE LIKELY FEELING RIGHT NOW AND HOW THIS DOC HELPS



Pain

You've gotten SO CLOSE to your ideal role 1-2 times, yet they slipped away



Joy

You understand what it takes to actually do well in final stage interviews

Fear

You are scared you won't get another good opportunity like the one you just got rejected in



Reassurance

You understand that you will have a much bigger chance of getting the offer when you get your next chance



FACE TO FACE INTERVIEWS

What do they actually test?

Interviews are not about knowledge. They test these things, ordered by importance:

- **Competence and Confidence:** Are you good at what you do? Can you show that in an interview confidently?
- **Energy and likeability:** Would they enjoy working with you? Would they remember you after interviewing 20 candidates?
- **Self-awareness and Transparency:** Do you know your strengths and weaknesses? Can you show interviewers that you are speaking the truth?

The first 5 minutes of your interview is going to be more important than the rest of the interview

Why?

Interviews are about impressions. Make a good one early, and the interviewer stays engaged and generous toward you for the rest of it. Make a bad one, and you're fighting an uphill battle no matter how well you answer later.

HOW DO I MAKE A GOOD IMPRESSION



1. Have a 'killer' self intro

The "DUE" strategy

D = Due Diligence (first 30 sec)

Cover your due diligence information, including:

- Degree
- Uni
- Relevant experience (internship/society) → don't need to go deep into exact role details (your resume is already read or in front of them)

U = Unique Story/Fact (45 sec)

One unique fact about yourself, relevant to the company (max 45 seconds): the key to stand out from the bunch!

How do I find these unique facts?

Fun fact: You already have them. You just need a third opinion to validate and point out these unique stories. Here is a practical step by step on how to extract them.

1. Write down every single memorable activity you have done since High School to Today
2. Write down your target field (ie marketing / accounting / software engineer)
3. List out 2 memorable incidents per activity, that is related to your target field
4. Find a person that is already inside the industry / have an internship at least
5. Present your timeline to them to ask them to highlight what is interesting about yourself (If you cannot find that person - [we can help you](#))
6. Extract 1 unique fact that the most relevant to this role

Time Required: 2-4 hours

E = Excited to be here (10 sec)

Aim to show that you are passionate and excited

2. Make a personal connection Starting from 'How are you'

We've seen so many mentee jump straight into interviews without trying to make personal connections, and most of them tell us they feel 'disconnected' in some shape or form.

To improve this, we **MUST capitalise the first 'How are you' conversation.**

It isn't filler. It's the first chance to come across as a real person before the formal questions start.

How to always make sure there is small talk?

Prepare prepare prepare!

Think:

- Something you did on the weekend (if the Interview is on Monday/Tuesday)
- A hobby you did yesterday(if Interview's on Wednesday) ***Bonus points if it overlaps with a hobby you spotted on the interviewer's LinkedIn***
- Something you did this morning, or on your way to the interview
- The weather, if it shifted noticeably

After sharing about yourself, always flip it back: "And how about you?" or "How's your week been?" It gives them a chance to talk and builds rapport before the real questions start.

Bonus Tips



Structure to nail "What's your biggest weakness"

- How you identified your weakness
- Why you decided to make a change
- Step 1, 2, 3 of your approach (clearly laid out)
- Results of the actions you took

My own example:

My Weakness → Bad at challenging others' opinions

- How I realised: I'd disagree with my groupmates internally but never voice it
- Why change: A lecturer praised an idea that was literally mine, but I'd never said it out loud
- Step 1: Reached out to a friend who's a debater for advice
- Step 2: Started small. Began challenging friends in normal conversations
- Step 3: Recorded the small wins in a journal to build confidence
- Results: Can voice an opposing opinion without feeling awkward (not perfect yet but improving)

Behavioural answer structure

BARL method

- Background: clear situation and your task (not more than 30s)

Common mistake: people over-explain the background, interviewers don't care that much and would lose attention quickly

- Action: clear steps on how you achieved it

Use conjunctions to create a separation of the steps, or before you go through the actions, literally say 'Here are the 3 steps I took' - showcase clear actions to interviewers

- Result: Quantifiable (Number) or Specific

- Learning: What you learnt or what is something that reassured your beliefs?

[We also offer mentoring to help you craft EVERY interview question based on your unique situation](#)



GROUP CASE STUDIES

Format:

3 to 6 people in a group, around 30 minutes of discussion time, 10 minutes of presentation time.

What kinds of case study?

Mostly broad topics within the industry or role you are applying for. In terms of difficulty and knowledge, they are not going to be like a uni exam.

What interviewers are observing:

Whether you are collaborating well with teammates.

Whether you can lead the team forward while displaying qualities.

Whether you have the knowledge or thinking to answer questions well.

Practical quick wins against other candidates (You can do this easily next time)

1. Bring a stack of paper and highlighters for everyone.
2. Offer to time-keep, and suggest presentation role allocation before time runs out.
3. Offer to write down notes for the team during discussion.

Bonus Tips x3 to stand out:



Why?

Draw a summary

Before moving on to next discussion question. Draw a summary of the aligned discussion points to make sure everyone agrees



Showcase Leadership skills

A leader would ensure the team is on the same page before progressing

Use simple Business Frameworks

Preparing general frameworks to introduce to the group / help you generate good ideas, ie PESTLE and 4Cs (Customer, Competition, Company, Context)



Showcase Business Knowledge

Being able to dissect a topic into different dimensions showcases good critical thinking skills

Looking out for others

Give the quiet students a chance to speak, if you notice they haven't spoken in a while



Showcase Leadership skills

A leader would care about everyone's input, and the wellbeing of other teammates

INDIVIDUAL CASE STUDY



They exist in most junior role interviews (non graduate programs)

Format:

30-60 minutes clock for you to answer a variety of questions, and presenting the results back to interviewers after the clock runs out

What kinds of individual case study?

Depending on the industry, they differ. For business roles, they may be a business case study, analytics roles would involve an excel exercise, tech roles would be scenario-based ("design X for Y user", "a metric dropped, diagnose it")

To understand the potential case studies that is common in your industry, [talk to a mentor in your target industry that went through the same process as you](#)

Bonus tips



Honest Uncertainty: If stuck, say what you've tried and ask for guidance rather than guessing wrong.

Show Your Method: Walk through how you got the answer, not just the answer itself, to demonstrate your thinking.

TO ADVANCE TO THE NEXT STAGE, YOU HAVE TO:

1. Get 1 offer!
2. That's it! You got it! Now go smash it

P.S.

Still want some final practise before the final boss?
We can help you practise and improve

▶ **SECURE A SPOT FOR MENTORSHIP WITH US,**
BEFORE YOUR COMPETITOR FINDS US! ◀

TO BUILD THE FOUNDATION, YOU MUST AT LEAST **ACHIEVE 3 OUT OF 6** OF THE FOLLOWING FEATURES OF A STRONG CANDIDATE

Based on:

- Conversations with 500+ students/grads
- 30+ offers secured across Tech/Business/Engineering

1. Relevant Internship Experience



- Local internship preferred; one from home country also works, as it builds employer confidence you can do the job
- This is the "**juice**" to your resume/LinkedIn
- Virtual internships (e.g. Forage) don't count as valid internship experience to most hirers

2. Society Executive Role



- Being an Executive = leading a function of the society, sometimes managing sub-committees
- Gives you "real world experience" distinct from internships

3. 85+ WAM / Relevant Professional Certificates / Wins in Case Competitions



- Grades matter only above 85+
- A relevant, widely recognized certificate (e.g. CFA for Finance, CISSP for Cyber Security) makes a difference
- Case comp wins count if top 3 or similarly notable

4. Relevant Passion Project



- Showcases proactivity and interest in the field
- Must have **direct impact** on your daily life or social circle, **preferably quantifiable**
- AI can help execute the project, but *direct impact is non-negotiable*

5. Unique Personal Story / Fun Facts



- Everyone has unique stories
- Unique stories make you memorable among hundreds of applicants
- 1-2 relevant fun facts about yourself can help you stand out immediately

6. Australia Job Experience (can be casual roles/volunteering)



- Local experience is **KING**, it shows you can communicate with people in Australia
- Casual or part-time work reassures employers on communication skills
- No job? Volunteering works too, if done consistently (e.g. once every 2 weeks)

I DON'T HAVE 3 OUT OF 6 WHAT DO I DO?



We understand all features are not easy to obtain in a short period of time, especially for society exec roles, internships, 85+ WAM. **However, don't be discouraged as there are 3 things we can start TODAY!**

Unique Personal Story / Fun Facts



Fun fact: You already have them. You just need a third opinion to validate and point out these unique stories. Here is a practical step by step on how to extract them.

1. Write down every single memorable activity you have done since High School to Today
2. Write down your target field (ie marketing / accounting / software engineer)
3. List out 2 memorable incidents per activity, that is related to your target field
4. Find a person that is already inside the industry / have an internship at least
5. Present your timeline to them to ask them to highlight what is interesting about yourself (If you cannot find that person - [we can help you](#))

Time Required: 2-4 hours

Where can you utilise these unique stories:

- LinkedIn 'abouts' page
- Resume professional profile
- Interview answers



Relevant Passion Project

Please understand your passion project should not be 'Generic AI Slop'.

Here are some idea avenues that are accepted across every field:

- Non-assignment related academic researches
- Technical tools that enhances your life / life of your social circle (ie A finance tracker)
- Blogs / Articles posted regularly
- Business Ideas to make money (has to be related to your field, or a part of business that has to use your particular skills in your field)

Time Required: 3-4 weeks

Where can you utilise these unique stories:

- LinkedIn + Resume Experiences
- Interview answers

Key to a successful passion project:



1. **Must generate an impact/results**, ie:

- saved \$ amount of money
- got x amount of user
- got x amount of likes of a social media post
- made x amount of money
- got recognition from professor

2. **You must have worked a combined of 20+ hours towards the passion project.**

When you work hard towards a project, you'd actually gain the confidence in your hard work, and this confidence is the **difference maker, especially during interview stages. Trust us, we have talked to 600+ mentees, recruiters, managers - and everyone can easily tell if your passion project is some 'AI slop' or the real deal.**

Want to make sure your passion project actually contributes to you being a strong candidate? [We provide real expertise from industry professionals that made it because of passion projects, through 1v1 mentorship.](#)

Australia Job Experience (can be casual / part time roles / volunteering)

Casual / Part time roles



How to get a casual / part time job, 3 ways, ranged from Easiest to Hardest:

1. Text every single friend of yours in Australia if their part time work place has any vacancies
2. Online applications
3. Print a resume of your past casual job history, go to the suburbs near you, walk in every shop and introduce yourself + ask if you can hand a resume to the manager

To understand deeper the difference between casual job applications, or what to include in a casual job resume. [Book a free call here](#) so we connect you to a mentor who previously did a part time job.

Time Required: 4-8 weeks

Where can you utilise this experience:

- LinkedIn + Resume Experiences
- Interview answers

Volunteering

To find volunteering activities that are available, insert this prompt to your LLM of choice:

Context: I live in [Insert suburb and state]. I'm building a candidacy for [Insert field].

Task: Find 5 volunteer opportunities that could strengthen this candidacy.

Criteria (all must apply):

- In or related to [Insert field]
- Involves teamwork: regular interaction/collaboration with other volunteers, not solo work
- Easy to get accepted (minimal vetting/interview process)
- Can start within 1 month from today
- Ongoing/regular commitment (not a one-off event)

Output format per option:

- Name + hyperlink
- 1-2 sentence description
- Acceptance difficulty rating (Easy / Medium / Hard, with a one-line reason why)